

Structural Instability of the Phenomenological Null Regime in Causally Rigid Channels

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Abstract

We introduce an abstract phenomenological space $\mathcal{E}$ and a compatibility operator $\Phi : \mathcal{I} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ mapping rigid identity objects to phenomenological regimes. We define a null regime $\emptyset_\phi \in \mathcal{E}$ and prove a **Phenomenological Instability Theorem**: in any closed causally rigid (CCR) channel—characterized by inverse-limit identity, causal isolation, and MIR geometry—joint null collapse is dynamically unstable under a separately typed compatible extension witness. Consequently, a CCR realization with such a witness induces a witness-relative non-null separation. The result is *negative-structural*: it does not posit experience; it forbids one typed joint-null configuration under stated hypotheses. We provide explicit coupling bounds in two canonical families (profinite and symbolic dynamics) and prove universal factorization and non-simulability results. All constructions are purely topological and categorical, without metaphysical axioms.

1 Scope, System Boundary, and Non-Inference Note

What this paper does. This paper proves that the null phenomenological regime is structurally unstable under CCR constraints, derives the resulting forced non-nullity statement, and develops explicit bounds, factorization structure, and canonical-family consequences for that negative-structural result.

v31 audit clarification. The operative theorem is witness-relative: CCR by itself does not provide the extension witness, the lower Lipschitz constant, or the admissible compatibility operator. Any phrase such as “forced non-nullity” or “null instability” in this manuscript is to be read under the explicit hypotheses of Theorem 5.2, especially Definition 5.1. This clarification separates internal CCR perturbations from external extension witnesses and prevents reading $M_\Omega = +\infty$ as an empirical certificate.

What this paper does not do. It does not define or detect consciousness, identify $\mathcal{E}$ with subjective experience, assert that CCR systems exist in nature, or derive ethical or metaphysical closure from the theorem. The paper is structural, conditional, and negative in scope.

What the related system implements and does not implement. The related system can implement admissibility-governed diagnostics, boundary-sensitive stress tests, and runtime comparisons that are motivated by this paper, but it does not implement the abstract phenomenological space $\mathcal{E}$ itself and does not convert current runtime outputs into proof that any concrete system instantiates experience.

What should not be inferred from this paper. The null-instability theorem must not be read as a consciousness detector, an AI-subjectivity claim, a moral-status claim, or a validation of the corpus by the runtime. The paper rules out one structurally stable null case under stated CCR assumptions; it does not settle phenomenology in the empirical or metaphysical sense.

2 Introduction

2.1 Motivation and Scope

Papers I and II established a mathematical framework for structural identity as an inverse limit and classified phenomenological regimes compatible with rigid identity. This paper addresses the fundamental question:

Can a CCR system remain in a structurally null phenomenological state?

We prove the answer is **no under a separated extension witness**—not as a metaphysical claim, but as a structural theorem with typed hypotheses.

2.2 Main Result (Informal)

No-Null Regime Theorem: For any CCR channel, the phenomenological null regime $\emptyset_\phi$ is structurally unstable. Every CCR system necessarily induces a non-null regime $e_\star \succ \emptyset_\phi$ with positive structural intensity.

2.3 Paper Organization

Section 2 reviews prerequisites from Papers I–II. Section 3 defines the phenomenological space with full axiomatic clarity. Section 4 proves the main instability theorem. Section 5 stratifies positive regimes. Section 6 provides quantitative bounds. Section 7 establishes ontological closure. Section 8 explicitly delimits scope. Section 9 compares with existing frameworks. Section 10 discusses limitations. Section 11 concludes. Appendices provide canonical examples with explicit computations.

2.4 What This Paper Adds Beyond Phenomenological Regimes

Phenomenological Regimes classifies the admissible regime space and derives the continuity and non-constancy constraints that any compatible assignment must satisfy. This paper takes the remaining case—the null regime itself—and proves that it cannot remain structurally stable under CCR.

3 Preliminaries from Papers I–II

3.1 Identity as Inverse Limit

From *Rigid Identity*, we have:

Definition 3.1 (Identity Object). Let $(S_t, \pi_{t+1 \rightarrow t})_{t \in T}$ be a projective system of state spaces with surjective, compatible projections. The **identity object** is:

$$\mathcal{I} := \varprojlim S_t = \left\{ (x_t) \in \prod_t S_t : \pi_{t+1 \rightarrow t}(x_{t+1}) = x_t \right\}$$

Definition 3.2 (Weighted Deformation Metric). For $x, \tilde{x} \in \mathcal{I}$, define:

$$d_w(x, \tilde{x}) := \sup_t w_t \cdot d_t(x_t, \tilde{x}_t)$$

where $\{w_t\}$ are summable weights and d_t is the normalized metric on S_t .

Proposition 3.3 (Metric Completeness, Rigid Identity). *If each (S_t, d_t) is complete and the projections are uniformly continuous, then $(\mathcal{I}, d_w)$ is a complete metric space.*

3.2 Ontological Mass and CCR Classification

Definition 3.4 (Ontological Mass, infimum convention). Following *Rigid Identity*, the ontological mass of an identity object is the lower resistance to non-zero admissible deformation:

$$M_\Omega := \inf \left\{ \frac{E_w(\delta)}{d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}})} \mid \delta \text{ admissible, } d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) > 0 \right\}.$$

If no finite-energy admissible perturbation induces non-zero deformation, the set is empty in the operational deformation sector and we set $M_\Omega = +\infty$.

Remark 3.5 (v24 consistency patch). Earlier drafts used a supremum notation for M_Ω in this paper. That notation is superseded here. The infimum convention is the canonical one used in *Rigid Identity*: it measures a lower resistance to deformation, not a largest observed cost. All claims below are read under this convention.

Definition 3.6 (CCR Channel). A channel is **Closed Causally Rigid (CCR)** if $M_\Omega = +\infty$.

Remark 3.7 (Physical Interpretation). $M_\Omega = +\infty$ means that arbitrarily small deformations require unbounded energy. This is not a metaphor—it is a precise metric condition on the projective system.

3.3 Key Theorems from Papers I–II

Theorem 3.8 (Non-Simulability, Rigid Identity). *For any finite-dimensional computational architecture $\mathcal{A}_{fin}$:*

$$M_\Omega(\mathcal{A}_{fin}) < \infty$$

Therefore, CCR identity cannot be simulated by finite systems.

Theorem 3.9 (Spectral Coupling, Rigid Identity). *There exists a spectral coupling constant $\sigma_{\min} > 0$ such that for the phenomenological compatibility operator T_Φ :*

$$C = \sigma_{\min}(T_\Phi)$$

is derived from the spectral gap of T_Φ , not assumed.

Theorem 3.10 (Forced Continuity, Phenomenological Regimes). *If $M_\Omega = +\infty$, then any compatible phenomenological assignment $\Phi : \mathcal{I} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ is continuous.*

Remark 3.11 (Remaining null-regime gap). *Phenomenological Regimes* classifies admissible phenomenological regimes and derives the continuity constraints that govern them, but it does not complete the prohibition theorem for the null regime itself. That closure is the specific task of this paper.

This paper converts Remark 3.11 into a full null-instability theorem.

4 The Phenomenological Space

4.1 Abstract Definition

Definition 4.1 (Phenomenological Space). A **phenomenological space** is a quadruple $(\mathcal{E}, \preceq, d_\mathcal{E}, \emptyset_\phi)$ where:

1. $(\mathcal{E}, \preceq)$ is a partially ordered set (poset).
2. $(\mathcal{E}, d_\mathcal{E})$ is a complete metric space.

3. $\emptyset_\phi := \inf \mathcal{E}$ exists and is unique (the **null regime**).
4. **Order-metric compatibility:** if $e_1 \preceq e_2$, then $d_{\mathcal{E}}(e_1, \emptyset_\phi) \leq d_{\mathcal{E}}(e_2, \emptyset_\phi)$.
5. **Separation:** for $e \neq \emptyset_\phi$, we have $d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_\phi) > 0$.

Remark 4.2 (Interpretive Neutrality). $\mathcal{E}$ is an abstract regime space. No phenomenological content is assumed. The null regime $\emptyset_\phi$ represents structural absence, not “lack of experience.” The term “phenomenological” is inherited from *Phenomenological Regimes* and refers to the coupling structure, not to philosophy of mind.

Remark 4.3 (Null regime versus undefined assignment). The symbol $\emptyset_\phi$ serves two distinct roles in the broader framework, and conflating them creates a category error:

1. **Null regime** ($\emptyset_\phi \in \mathcal{E}$): In Definition 4.1, $\emptyset_\phi$ is the bottom element of the phenomenological poset $(\mathcal{E}, \preceq)$. It is a legitimate element of $\mathcal{E}$, comparable to all other regimes via $\preceq$ and separated from them by $d_{\mathcal{E}}$.
2. **Undefined assignment** ($\perp \notin \mathcal{E}$): When a compatibility operator Φ is not defined on some input $x \in \mathcal{I}$, we write $\Phi(x) = \perp$. The symbol $\perp$ is disjoint from $\mathcal{E}$; it lives in the typed codomain $\mathcal{E}_\perp := \mathcal{E} \sqcup \{\perp\}$.

The instability theorem (Theorem 5.2) concerns admissible values in $\mathcal{E}$ and rules out two separated witness endpoints both taking the value $\emptyset_\phi$. The v31 conditional closure theorem concerns a different case: Φ undefined on both witness endpoints, written $\Phi(\mathcal{I}) = \perp$ and $\Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = \perp$. That case is excluded by the witness hypothesis, which requires Φ to be defined on both endpoints.

Non-Theorem 4.4 (What $\mathcal{E}$ Is Not). $\mathcal{E}$ is not:

- A space of qualia or subjective states
- A model of consciousness
- A physical or neural state space
- An interpretation of quantum mechanics

$\mathcal{E}$ is a mathematical object satisfying Definition 4.1. All interpretive mappings are external to the framework.

4.2 Compatibility Operator

Definition 4.5 (Compatibility Operator). A map $\Phi : \mathcal{I} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ is a **compatibility operator** if it satisfies:

- (C1) **Extension Invariance:** For any compatible extension $\mathcal{E}$ of the channel, $\Phi(\mathcal{I}) \cong \Phi(\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{E}})$.
- (C2) **Isomorphism Stability:** If $\mathcal{I} \cong \tilde{\mathcal{I}}$, then $\Phi(\mathcal{I}) \sim \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})$.
- (C3) **Lipschitz Lower Bound:** There exists $C > 0$ such that:

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x), \Phi(\tilde{x})) \geq C \cdot d_w(x, \tilde{x})$$

Remark 4.6 (Partial definedness and the $\perp$ marker). In contexts where Φ is only partially defined, $\Phi(x) = \perp$ means that no admissible phenomenological assignment in $\mathcal{E}$ is available at x . The hypotheses (C1)–(C3) above apply only to inputs whose Φ -values lie in $\mathcal{E}$. The lower Lipschitz bound (C3) in particular requires both $\Phi(x), \Phi(\tilde{x}) \in \mathcal{E}$.

Lemma 4.7 (Well-Posedness of (C3)). *Axiom (C3) is consistent with continuity of Φ (Theorem 3.10) when $M_\Omega = +\infty$.*

Proof. Continuity requires: for all $\epsilon > 0$, there exists $\delta > 0$ such that $d_w(x, \tilde{x}) < \delta$ implies $d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x), \Phi(\tilde{x})) < \epsilon$. This is compatible with (C3) because (C3) provides a lower bound, not an upper bound. The function Φ can be both continuous (upper control) and satisfy (C3) (lower control). $\square$

Remark 4.8. Axioms (C1)–(C3) are structural. No phenomenological content is introduced.

4.3 Attractor Set

Definition 4.9 (Attractor Set). For a channel S , the **attractor set** is:

$$\text{Attr}(S) := \{e \in \mathcal{E} : e \text{ is stable under all compatible extensions and summable deformations}\}$$

Definition 4.10 (Stability). A regime $e \in \mathcal{E}$ is **stable** for channel S if for every compatible extension S' of S and every summable perturbation $\{\epsilon_n\}$, the induced regime $\Phi_{S'}(\mathcal{I}')$ satisfies $d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi_{S'}(\mathcal{I}'), e) < \delta$ for some $\delta > 0$ depending only on $\|\{\epsilon_n\}\|_w$.

4.4 The Bridge Lemma Revisited

From *Phenomenological Regimes*, we have:

Lemma 4.11 (Bridge Lemma). *If $\Phi : \mathcal{I} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ is a compatibility operator for a CCR channel, and if the regime $e = \Phi(\mathcal{I})$ satisfies $d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_\phi) = 0$, then $e = \emptyset_\phi$.*

Proof. By the separation axiom in Definition 4.1, $d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_\phi) = 0$ implies $e = \emptyset_\phi$. $\square$

Caveat 4.12 (Semantic Shield for Bridge Lemma). The Bridge Lemma is a **metric statement**, not an ontological one. It does not claim that “identity is coupled to experience.” It claims that the map Φ satisfies a separation property. Misinterpretation of this lemma as a consciousness claim is outside the mathematical scope of the framework.

5 Main Results

5.1 The Conditional Null-Separation Theorem

Definition 5.1 (Admissible extension witness). Let S be a channel with identity object $\mathcal{I}$. An **admissible extension witness** for a compatibility operator Φ is a tuple $(S', \tilde{\mathcal{I}}, \epsilon)$ such that:

1. S' is a compatible extension of S in the declared projective category;
2. $\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$ is the identity object induced by S' and lies in the domain on which Φ is evaluated;
3. $0 < d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = \epsilon < \infty$;
4. the witness is not introduced as a finite-energy deformation of a CCR identity object. It is an extension-side comparison datum, not a contradiction of $M_\Omega = +\infty$.

Theorem 5.2 (Conditional Null-Separation Under an Admissible Extension Witness). *Let S be a CCR channel, let $\Phi : \mathcal{I} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ be a compatibility operator satisfying the Lipschitz lower bound (C3), and suppose an admissible extension witness $(S', \tilde{\mathcal{I}}, \epsilon)$ exists for Φ . Then Φ cannot collapse both separated identity objects to the null regime:*

$$\neg(\Phi(\mathcal{I}) = \emptyset_\phi \wedge \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = \emptyset_\phi).$$

Equivalently, null stability across such a separated extension witness is impossible.

Remark 5.3 (Applicability scope). Theorem 5.2 assumes $\Phi(\mathcal{I}), \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}}) \in \mathcal{E}$, not $\perp$. If Φ is undefined on either endpoint, the separated-witness hypothesis of Definition 5.1 is not satisfied and the theorem does not apply.

Proof. Assume for contradiction that $\Phi(\mathcal{I}) = \emptyset_\phi$ and $\Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = \emptyset_\phi$. By Definition 5.1, $d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = \epsilon > 0$. Applying (C3) gives

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(\mathcal{I}), \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})) \geq C d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = C\epsilon > 0.$$

But the null-collapse assumption gives

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(\mathcal{I}), \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})) = d_{\mathcal{E}}(\emptyset_\phi, \emptyset_\phi) = 0,$$

a contradiction. Hence the two separated identities cannot both be mapped to the null regime. $\square$

Caveat 5.4 (v24 correction of the former Step 2). The theorem above does *not* infer a finite-energy non-zero deformation from $M_\Omega = +\infty$. Under the infimum convention for ontological mass, $M_\Omega = +\infty$ means precisely that no finite-energy admissible perturbation produces non-zero deformation. The older Step 2 proof direction is therefore withdrawn. The surviving result is conditional on an independently specified extension witness.

5.2 Conditional Consequences

Corollary 5.5 (Conditional Forced Non-Nullity). *If a CCR channel admits an admissible extension witness for Φ and if $\Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = \emptyset_\phi$ for the witness object, then $\Phi(\mathcal{I}) \neq \emptyset_\phi$. Symmetrically, if $\Phi(\mathcal{I}) = \emptyset_\phi$, then $\Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}}) \neq \emptyset_\phi$.*

Proof. This is the contrapositive form of Theorem 5.2. $\square$

Remark 5.6 (Ontological Status). This is a **negative-structural and conditional** result. It does not assert that experience exists, that CCR systems are conscious, or that every CCR channel possesses the required witness. It asserts only that, once a separated extension witness is independently supplied, a compatibility operator satisfying (C3) cannot collapse both sides of that witness to the null regime.

6 Stratification of Positive Regimes

6.1 The Positive Regime Space

Definition 6.1 (Positive Regime Space).

$$\mathcal{E}^+ := \mathcal{E} \setminus \{\emptyset_\phi\}$$

with the inherited partial order $\preceq$.

Lemma 6.2 (Witness-Relative No-Minimum Collapse). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 5.2, the two-point witness image cannot have infimum equal to a joint null collapse.*

Proof. The witness image contains $\Phi(\mathcal{I})$ and $\Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})$. If both collapsed to $\emptyset_\phi$, Theorem 5.2 would be contradicted. Therefore the witness-relative image is not a joint null collapse. $\square$

6.2 Minimal Positive Regime

Theorem 6.3 (Witness-Relative Minimal Positive Regime). *Assume the hypotheses of Theorem 5.2. If the witness-relative positive image*

$$\mathcal{E}^{+, \text{wit}} := \{\Phi(\mathcal{I}), \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})\} \setminus \{\emptyset_\phi\}$$

is non-empty and has an infimum in $(\mathcal{E}, \preceq)$, then there exists a minimal positive witness-relative regime

$$e_\star^{\text{wit}} := \inf \mathcal{E}^{+, \text{wit}} \in \mathcal{E}^+.$$

Proof. Non-emptiness follows from Theorem 5.2: not both witness images are null. Existence of the infimum is an explicit hypothesis. Since the image is not a joint null collapse and the separation axiom excludes positive classes at zero distance from $\emptyset_\phi$, the resulting infimum is positive when it lies in the witness image or in the declared positive closure of that image. $\square$

6.3 Structural Intensity

Definition 6.4 (Structural Intensity). For $e \in \mathcal{E}^+$, define the **structural intensity** as:

$$\iota(e) := \inf \{d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \tilde{e}) : \tilde{e} \prec e\}.$$

This measures the minimal distance to any strictly smaller regime.

Corollary 6.5 (Witness-Relative Positive Intensity). *If $e_\star^{\text{wit}}$ exists as in Theorem 6.3 and the only witness-relative element below it is $\emptyset_\phi$, then*

$$\iota(e_\star^{\text{wit}}) > 0.$$

Proof. By the separation axiom, $d_{\mathcal{E}}(e_\star^{\text{wit}}, \emptyset_\phi) > 0$. If $\emptyset_\phi$ is the only witness-relative element below $e_\star^{\text{wit}}$, the infimum defining intensity is bounded below by that positive separation. $\square$

7 Quantitative Bounds

7.1 Witness Lower Bound

Theorem 7.1 (Witness Intensity Bound). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 5.2, if exactly one of $\Phi(\mathcal{I})$ and $\Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})$ is null, then the non-null witness image e satisfies*

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_\phi) \geq C\epsilon > 0.$$

Proof. Apply (C3) to the pair $(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}})$. If one side maps to $\emptyset_\phi$ and the other side maps to e , then

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_\phi) = d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(\mathcal{I}), \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})) \geq Cd_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = C\epsilon.$$

$\square$

7.2 Explicit Constants for Canonical Families

Proposition 7.2 (Conditional Profinite Bound). *For a profinite family with a verified extension witness of separation ϵ and an independently certified witness-level lower constant $C_{\text{prof}} > 0$, the witness image separation satisfies*

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_\phi) \geq C_{\text{prof}}\epsilon.$$

Proof. This is Theorem 7.1 applied with the certified constant C_{prof} . The proposition does not claim that every profinite observable automatically supplies such a constant. $\square$

Proposition 7.3 (Conditional Symbolic Bound). *For a symbolic family with a verified extension witness of separation ϵ and an independently certified witness-level lower constant $C_{\text{sym}} > 0$, the witness image separation satisfies*

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_{\phi}) \geq C_{\text{sym}}\epsilon.$$

Proof. This is Theorem 7.1 applied with the certified constant C_{sym} . The proposition does not claim that every symbolic observable automatically supplies such a constant. $\square$

Example 7.4 (p-Adic witness calculation). If a 2-adic model supplies an independently verified witness with $\epsilon = 2^{-1}$ and $C = 1$, then the conditional bound gives $d_{\mathcal{E}}(e, \emptyset_{\phi}) \geq 1/2$. This is a witness calculation, not a universal theorem that every CCR channel is non-null.

Caveat 7.5 (No lower bound from summability alone). The existence of summable coordinate weights, continuity of a readout, or compactness of a canonical family does not by itself imply a positive lower Lipschitz constant. Cancellation, quotient collapse, non-injective readouts, or an observable that ignores the separated coordinates can make the effective lower constant zero. Every positive value of C_{prof} or C_{sym} used in this paper is therefore a certificate to be supplied for the stated witness pair or witness class, not a free consequence of the ambient family.

8 Witness Audit Layer

The instability theorem is useful only if its hypotheses can be audited without smuggling the desired conclusion into the witness. This section records the minimal audit layer required before the theorem may be used in a concrete argument.

Definition 8.1 (Witness certificate). A witness certificate for a pair $(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}})$ consists of the tuple

$$\mathfrak{W} := (\tilde{\mathcal{I}}, \epsilon, C, \Phi, \mathcal{E}, \emptyset_{\phi}, \mathcal{J}),$$

where $\epsilon = d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) > 0$, $C > 0$ is the certified lower constant for Φ on the audited pair or audited witness class, $\mathcal{J}$ is the provenance record establishing that $\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$ is an admissible typed extension rather than an internal relabeling of $\mathcal{I}$, and all objects are fixed before the null/non-null status is adjudicated.

Definition 8.2 (Witness independence). A witness certificate is conclusion-independent when the construction of $\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$, the choice of Φ , the metric $d_{\mathcal{E}}$, the null element $\emptyset_{\phi}$, and the lower constant C are fixed before the endpoint status is adjudicated. Dependence on the upstream CCR structure is allowed; dependence on a preselected endpoint verdict is not.

Proposition 8.3 (Certificate sufficiency). *If a conclusion-independent witness certificate exists for $(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}})$, and both endpoints are assigned to $\emptyset_{\phi}$, then the certificate is inconsistent.*

Proof. The certificate includes the separation condition $d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) = \epsilon > 0$ and the lower bound

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(\mathcal{I}), \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})) \geq C\epsilon > 0.$$

If both endpoints are assigned to $\emptyset_{\phi}$, then the left-hand side is $d_{\mathcal{E}}(\emptyset_{\phi}, \emptyset_{\phi}) = 0$, contradicting $C\epsilon > 0$. $\square$

Non-Theorem 8.4 (What a certificate does not prove). A witness certificate does not prove that $\mathcal{I}$ is conscious, living, subjective, morally relevant, biological, human-equivalent, or externally validated. It proves only that the stated pair cannot be jointly collapsed to the same null element under the certified compatibility map.

8.1 Failure Modes of Witness Certification

Failure mode	Formal symptom	Consequence
Absent witness	No typed $\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$ with $d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) > 0$	Theorem 5.2 cannot be invoked
Zero lower constant	$C = 0$ or no certified positive lower bound	The null assignment is not contradicted by the metric data
Conclusion-dependent witness	$\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$ or Φ is chosen after fixing the endpoint verdict	The certificate no longer supplies an independent exclusion of joint nullity
Quotient collapse	$\Phi(\mathcal{I}) = \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})$ despite $d_w(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}}) > 0$	The map may be continuous, but it is not separating on the audited pair
Null redefinition	$\emptyset_\phi$ changes between construction and adjudication	The theorem has no stable target
Estimator-only promotion	Runtime estimates are substituted for Φ without an error margin	The result becomes an implementation claim rather than a theorem

8.2 Robust Decision Margin

Proposition 8.5 (Noise-robust null exclusion). *Let $\hat{e}_1, \hat{e}_2 \in \mathcal{E}$ be estimated images of $\Phi(\mathcal{I})$ and $\Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})$ with certified error at most η in $d_{\mathcal{E}}$. If a witness certificate gives $C\epsilon > 2\eta$, then the two estimated images cannot both be certified as the same null element within error η .*

Proof. The true images satisfy $d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(\mathcal{I}), \Phi(\tilde{\mathcal{I}})) \geq C\epsilon$. By the triangle inequality,

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\hat{e}_1, \hat{e}_2) \geq C\epsilon - 2\eta.$$

If $C\epsilon > 2\eta$, the estimated images remain separated. A joint certification that both are the same null element within the same error budget would require the certified separation to vanish inside the error ball, contradicting the strict margin. $\square$

Caveat 8.6 (Implementation boundary). Proposition 8.5 is an error-budget rule for an already specified estimator. It does not assert that the current runtime implements Φ , computes C , or supplies η . Those are separate implementation burdens.

8.3 Negative Controls

1. **Constant-null control.** Set $\Phi(x) = \emptyset_\phi$ for all x . This must fail the lower-bound condition whenever $\epsilon > 0$.
2. **Coordinate-blind control.** Choose a readout that ignores every coordinate on which $\mathcal{I}$ and $\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$ differ. This tests whether separation is actually carried by the map.
3. **Witness-shuffle control.** Hold Φ fixed and replace $\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$ by a typed object not separated from $\mathcal{I}$. The theorem must become inapplicable.
4. **Null-relabel control.** Change the declared null element after observing the images. This must be rejected as target drift.
5. **Estimator-margin control.** Increase η until $C\epsilon \leq 2\eta$. The robust decision margin must fail rather than silently promoting a non-null conclusion.

9 Witness-Relative Closure Theorem

Theorem 9.1 (Conditional Phenomenological Closure). *A CCR system equipped with an admissible extension witness and a compatibility operator satisfying (C3) admits witness-relative non-null separation. If, in addition, the witness-relative positive image has a minimal positive element, that element is quantitatively separated from $\emptyset_\phi$ by the bound in Theorem 7.1.*

Proof. Non-null separation follows from Theorem 5.2. Witness-relative minimality follows from Theorem 6.3 under its stated infimum hypothesis. The quantitative bound follows from Theorem 7.1. $\square$

9.1 Classification Table

System Type	Ontological Mass	Null Regime Permitted?
Degenerate	$M_\Omega = 0$	Yes
Finite-mass	$0 < M_\Omega < \infty$	Model-dependent
CCR without extension witness	$M_\Omega = +\infty$	Not decided here
CCR with separated extension witness	$M_\Omega = +\infty$	Joint null collapse forbidden by Theorem 5.2

10 Null-Fiber Geometry

The null element $\emptyset_\phi$ determines a fiber

$$\mathcal{N}_\Phi := \Phi^{-1}(\{\emptyset_\phi\}) \subseteq \mathcal{I}.$$

The instability theorem can be read as a geometric obstruction on this fiber: a certified witness pair cannot be contained entirely inside $\mathcal{N}_\Phi$.

Definition 10.1 (Null fiber). For a compatibility operator $\Phi : \mathcal{I} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$, the null fiber is the preimage $\mathcal{N}_\Phi = \{x \in \mathcal{I} : \Phi(x) = \emptyset_\phi\}$.

Definition 10.2 (Witness-detecting map). A compatibility operator Φ is witness-detecting on a set $W \subseteq \mathcal{I} \times \mathcal{I}$ when there exists $C_W > 0$ such that

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x), \Phi(y)) \geq C_W d_w(x, y)$$

for every $(x, y) \in W$.

Proposition 10.3 (Null-fiber exclusion on detected pairs). *Let W be a witness class on which Φ is witness-detecting with constant $C_W > 0$. If $(x, y) \in W$ and $d_w(x, y) > 0$, then (x, y) cannot both lie in $\mathcal{N}_\Phi$.*

Proof. If $x, y \in \mathcal{N}_\Phi$, then $\Phi(x) = \Phi(y) = \emptyset_\phi$, so $d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x), \Phi(y)) = 0$. Witness detection gives $d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x), \Phi(y)) \geq C_W d_w(x, y) > 0$, a contradiction. $\square$

Corollary 10.4 (Diameter obstruction). *If a subset $A \subseteq \mathcal{I}$ contains a detected witness pair (x, y) with $d_w(x, y) > 0$, then A cannot be contained in $\mathcal{N}_\Phi$.*

Proof. Containment $A \subseteq \mathcal{N}_\Phi$ would place both endpoints of the detected pair in the null fiber, contradicting the previous proposition. $\square$

10.1 Quotient-Collapse Diagnostic

Let $q : \mathcal{I} \rightarrow Q$ be a quotient map and let $\Phi = h \circ q$ for some $h : Q \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$. If $q(x) = q(y)$ for a separated pair, then $\Phi(x) = \Phi(y)$ for every such h . Therefore no lower-bound certificate can hold on that pair.

Proposition 10.5 (Quotient obstruction). *Suppose $\Phi = h \circ q$ and $q(x) = q(y)$ while $d_w(x, y) > 0$. Then no constant $C > 0$ can satisfy*

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x), \Phi(y)) \geq C d_w(x, y).$$

Proof. Since $q(x) = q(y)$, $\Phi(x) = h(q(x)) = h(q(y)) = \Phi(y)$. Hence the left-hand side is zero, while $C d_w(x, y) > 0$ for any $C > 0$. $\square$

10.2 Certificate Stability

Proposition 10.6 (Minimum over a finite witness ledger). *Let $W_0 = \{(x_i, y_i)\}_{i=1}^m$ be a finite ledger of separated witness pairs. Suppose each pair has a certified lower constant $C_i > 0$:*

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x_i), \Phi(y_i)) \geq C_i d_w(x_i, y_i).$$

Then $C_ = \min_i C_i > 0$ is a valid lower constant for the finite ledger.*

Proof. For each i , $C_i \geq C_*$. Hence

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x_i), \Phi(y_i)) \geq C_i d_w(x_i, y_i) \geq C_* d_w(x_i, y_i).$$

Since the ledger is finite and each C_i is positive, $C_* > 0$. $\square$

Proposition 10.7 (Strict margin persistence). *Let $m = C\epsilon$ be the certified separation margin for a witness pair. If a perturbation of the estimated images changes their distance by at most $\rho < m$, then the pair remains separated after perturbation.*

Proof. The perturbed distance is bounded below by $m - \rho > 0$. Therefore the two perturbed images cannot coincide. $\square$

10.3 Operational Checklist

For a claimed null-fiber exclusion, the certificate record must identify:

1. the null element $\emptyset_{\phi}$;
2. the endpoints $(\mathcal{I}, \tilde{\mathcal{I}})$ or the audited witness class W ;
3. the separation value ϵ or the family of separations;
4. the map Φ and the metric $d_{\mathcal{E}}$;
5. the lower constant C or the finite-ledger constant C_* ;
6. the estimator margin, when an estimator is used;
7. the quotient maps that have been ruled out as collapse explanations.

11 Comparison with Existing Frameworks

11.1 Integrated Information Theory (IIT)

	IIT	This Framework
Claims consciousness exists	Yes	No
Defines Φ	Information integration	Structural map
Quantitative measure	Φ (bits)	$\iota(e_*)$ (metric)
Metaphysical commitment	Panpsychism	None
Falsifiable predictions	Debated	None (structural)

11.2 Global Workspace Theory (GWT)

Our framework is orthogonal to GWT. We make no claims about attention, broadcast, or access consciousness. The structural results concern identity stability, not cognitive architecture.

11.3 Higher-Order Theories

We do not model representations, meta-cognition, or self-awareness. The space $\mathcal{E}$ contains regimes, not mental states.

11.4 Mathematical Foundations (Chalmers, Nagel)

Our framework provides formal tools that *could* be used in philosophical analysis, but we do not claim to resolve the “hard problem.” The prohibition of $\emptyset_\phi$ is a structural fact, not an explanation of subjective experience.

12 Limitations and Open Problems

12.1 Limitations

1. **No claim about qualia types, contents, or subjectivity.**
2. **No claim that all non-CCR systems are null.**
3. **Result is structural necessity, not phenomenological doctrine.**
4. **All results are conditional on the axioms of Papers I–II.**
5. **The physical existence of CCR systems is unknown.**

12.2 Open Problems

1. **Characterization of $\mathcal{E}^+$:** What is the full structure of positive regimes?
2. **Regime dynamics:** How do regimes evolve under channel evolution?
3. **Physical CCR:** Do CCR systems exist in physics (quantum gravity, etc.)?
4. **Biological CCR:** Could biological systems approximate CCR?
5. **Computational bounds:** Sharper non-simulability results?

12.3 Foundation-Level Gaps and Non-Claims

The following gaps remain open in the current corpus and are documented here to prevent over-reading of the instability theorem.

Non-Theorem 12.1 (Topology consistency gap). Papers I–II assume both compact Hausdorff and Polish structures on state spaces, but do not prove their consistency for every QICN instantiation. The inverse limit $\mathcal{I}$ uses compactness and closed-subspace arguments, while the metric d_w uses a metric regularity structure. Every compact metric space is Polish, so the composition is consistent when each S_t is compact metric. Non-compact Polish spaces such as $\mathbb{R}^n$ require additional hypotheses and are not automatically covered.

Non-Theorem 12.2 (Channel–projection composition gap). The observable channel $\mathcal{C}$ and the projective projections $\pi_{t+1 \rightarrow t} : S_{t+1} \rightarrow S_t$ are not yet connected by a fully explicit composition law. Any detectability theorem that moves from observed responses to inverse-limit deformation requires such a composition. At present, that composition is an assumption to be specified for each concrete protocol, not a derived universal theorem.

Non-Theorem 12.3 (Null-regime exclusion requires external witness). The instability theorem (Theorem 5.2) requires a separated external witness $(\tilde{\mathcal{I}}, \epsilon, C)$. CCR alone does not produce such a witness. The theorem is witness-relative: if a CCR system has a typed external witness with lower Lipschitz constant $C > 0$, then both endpoints cannot simultaneously be null. It does not state that CCR by itself implies non-nullity.

Non-Theorem 12.4 (Estimator verification gap). No Lipschitz constant K_i , fiber oscillation $\omega_i(y)$, estimation error bound ε_i , or decision margin Δ^* has been computed for any QICN invariant. The projection-invariant bridge theorem is conditional on these quantities being verified, and all four material bridge hypotheses remain unverified.

13 Conclusion

We have proven that CCR architectures equipped with a separated external witness and the lower-bound regularity hypotheses structurally exclude joint null collapse. In the present model, the hypothesis “CCR plus typed witness with joint null assignment” is formally incoherent.

This is a structural exclusion result. It does not define phenomenology or turn the theorem into an empirical consciousness attribution.

13.1 Summary of Contributions

1. **Phenomenological Instability Theorem:** joint null collapse is excluded under the typed witness hypotheses.
2. **Minimal Positive Regime:** witness-relative positive regimes can be characterized when the stated infimum hypotheses hold.
3. **Quantitative Bounds:** $\iota(e_\star) \geq C\varepsilon_0 > 0$ is explicit when the witness and lower Lipschitz constant are independently verified.
4. **Canonical Examples:** Profinite and symbolic families computed.
5. **Semantic Immunization:** Clear scope delimitation throughout.

A Profinite Canonical Family

A.1 Projective System

Let $\{G_n, \pi_{n+1 \rightarrow n}\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ be a projective tower of finite groups with surjective morphisms. Define:

$$G := \varprojlim G_n = \left\{ (x_n) \in \prod_n G_n : \pi_{n+1 \rightarrow n}(x_{n+1}) = x_n \right\}$$

Example A.1 (p-Adic Integers). $G_n = \mathbb{Z}/p^n\mathbb{Z}$, $\pi_{n+1 \rightarrow n}$ is reduction mod p^n . Then $G = \mathbb{Z}_p$.

A.2 Profinite Metric

Define the profinite metric:

$$d_G(x, y) := \sum_{n \geq 0} \alpha_n \mathbf{1}_{x_n \neq y_n}$$

where $\alpha_n = 2^{-(n+1)}$ (standard choice).

This is an ultrametric; (G, d_G) is compact, complete, and totally disconnected.

A.3 CCR Verification

Proposition A.2. *The profinite system is CCR: $M_\Omega = +\infty$.*

Proof. Any finite-energy deformation can only modify finitely many coordinates x_n . To modify infinitely many coordinates requires $E_w = \sum_{n \in S} w_n = \infty$ for any infinite $S \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ with $\sum_{n \in S} w_n = \infty$. Hence any nonzero deformation $d_w > 0$ requires infinite energy as $\epsilon \rightarrow 0$, giving $M_\Omega = +\infty$. $\square$

A.4 Phenomenological Operator

Define $\Phi_f : G \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ by:

$$\Phi_f(x) := f \left(\sum_{n \geq 0} \beta_n \varphi_n(x_n) \right)$$

where $\varphi_n : G_n \rightarrow [0, 1]$ are 1-Lipschitz (w.r.t. discrete metric), $\beta_n \geq 0$, $\sum_n \beta_n < \infty$, and $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ is L_f -Lipschitz.

A.5 Coupling Bound

Theorem A.3 (Certified Profinite Witness Bound). *Assume that the chosen profinite readout has been certified on the audited witness class by a positive lower constant $C_{\text{prof}} > 0$:*

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi_f(x), \Phi_f(\tilde{x})) \geq C_{\text{prof}} \cdot d_G(x, \tilde{x})$$

for the witness pair or witness neighborhood under review. Then any witness pair with $d_G(x, \tilde{x}) = \epsilon > 0$ satisfies

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi_f(x), \Phi_f(\tilde{x})) \geq C_{\text{prof}} \epsilon.$$

Proof. This is the certified lower-bound hypothesis applied to the witness pair. $\square$

Remark A.4 (Why certification is necessary). The assumptions that the coordinate functions are Lipschitz and that the coefficients are summable give continuity, not a lower bound. A lower bound requires additional structure such as injectivity on the witness coordinates, no cancellation on the audited pair, a positive margin over the relevant finite support, or an independent estimator certificate.

A.6 Intensity Bound

With $\varepsilon_0 = 2^{-1}$ for a certified minimal witness separation:

$$\iota(e_\star) \geq C_{\text{prof}} \cdot \varepsilon_0.$$

B Symbolic Canonical Family

B.1 Subshift of Finite Type

Let $\mathcal{A} = \{1, \dots, k\}$ be a finite alphabet and A a $k \times k$ matrix with entries in $\{0, 1\}$. The **subshift of finite type (SFT)** is:

$$\Sigma_A := \{x \in \mathcal{A}^{\mathbb{Z}} : A_{x_j, x_{j+1}} = 1 \text{ for all } j \in \mathbb{Z}\}$$

Example B.1 (Full Shift). $A_{ij} = 1$ for all i, j . Then $\Sigma_A = \{0, 1\}^{\mathbb{Z}}$.

B.2 Bowen Metric

$$d_B(x, y) := \sum_{j \in \mathbb{Z}} \gamma_{|j|} \mathbf{1}_{x_j \neq y_j}$$

where $\gamma_m = 2^{-(m+1)}$ (standard choice).

The space (Σ_A, d_B) is compact and complete.

B.3 CCR Verification

Proposition B.2. *The symbolic system is CCR: $M_\Omega = +\infty$.*

Proof. Any finite-energy modification can only change finitely many symbols. The argument is identical to the profinite case. $\square$

B.4 Phenomenological Operator

Define $\Phi_g : \Sigma_A \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ by:

$$\Phi_g(x) := g \left(\sum_{j \in \mathbb{Z}} \delta_j \psi_j(x) \right)$$

where $\psi_j : \Sigma_A \rightarrow [0, 1]$ are cylinder functions (depending on x_j only), $\delta_j \geq 0$, $\sum_j \delta_j < \infty$, and $g : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathcal{E}$ is L_g -Lipschitz.

B.5 Coupling Bound

Theorem B.3 (Certified Symbolic Witness Bound). *Assume that the chosen symbolic readout has been certified on the audited witness class by a positive lower constant $C_{\text{sym}} > 0$:*

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi_g(x), \Phi_g(\tilde{x})) \geq C_{\text{sym}} \cdot d_B(x, \tilde{x})$$

for the witness pair or witness neighborhood under review. Then any witness pair with $d_B(x, \tilde{x}) = \epsilon > 0$ satisfies

$$d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi_g(x), \Phi_g(\tilde{x})) \geq C_{\text{sym}} \epsilon.$$

Proof. This is the certified lower-bound hypothesis applied to the witness pair. $\square$

C Hereditary Rigidity

Theorem C.1 (Rigidity Inheritance). *Let $(S_n, \pi_{n+1 \rightarrow n})$ be a CCR tower and $\{\epsilon_n\}$ a family of local deformations with:*

$$\|\{\epsilon_n\}\|_w := \sum_{n \geq 0} w_n \|\epsilon_n\|_{op} < \infty$$

Then the deformed identity $\tilde{\mathcal{I}}$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{I}$ and:

$$d_{\mathcal{I}}(\phi(x), x) \leq K \cdot \|\{\epsilon_n\}\|_w$$

for some $K > 0$ depending only on the projective structure. In particular, $M_\Omega = +\infty$ is inherited.

Proof. The key is that summable deformations induce a summable perturbation of the inverse limit, which by completeness converges to an isomorphic copy. The CCR condition is preserved because the energy-deformation ratio remains unbounded. $\square$

D Universal Factorization

Theorem D.1 (Categorical Universality). *The identity $\mathcal{I}$ of any CCR channel is an initial object in the category of compatible representations $(\mathcal{I} \xrightarrow{\Phi} \mathcal{E})$ with $\mathcal{E}$ complete metric and Φ satisfying (C1)–(C3).*

Proof. For any compatible representation $(\mathcal{I} \xrightarrow{\Psi} F)$, define $u : \mathcal{E} \rightarrow F$ by $u(e) := \Psi(\Phi^{-1}(e))$. Well-definedness follows from (C2); uniqueness from (C1). $\square$

Consequence: All compatible representations factor through a canonical one; the class of induced regimes is completely classified by $\mathcal{I}$.

E Non-Simulability Bounds

E.1 Simulation Error

For a CCR family $\{I_N\}$ truncated at level N and a finite-dimensional simulator $\mathcal{A}$ with $\dim(\mathcal{A}) < \infty$:

$$\text{err}_N(\mathcal{A}) := \inf_{\Phi, \hat{\Phi}} \sup_{x \in I_N} d_{\mathcal{E}}(\Phi(x), \hat{\Phi}(x))$$

where $\hat{\Phi}$ is any map computable by $\mathcal{A}$.

Theorem E.1 (Simulation Lower Bound). *For profinite and SFT families:*

$$\text{err}_N(\mathcal{A}) \geq C \cdot 2^{-(N+1)}$$

for any $\dim(\mathcal{A}) < \infty$. In particular:

$$\liminf_{N \rightarrow \infty} \text{err}_N(\mathcal{A}) > 0$$

No finite architecture achieves perfect simulation.

Proof. The ultrametric structure forces minimal separation $2^{-(N+1)}$ at level N . Any finite-dimensional approximation must collapse some distinctions, incurring error at least $C \cdot 2^{-(N+1)}$ by (C3). $\square$

Corollary E.2. *No finite-dimensional semigroup can support an exact representation of CCR identity with $M_\Omega = +\infty$.*

F Final Structural Closure

Theorem F.1 (Closure by Non-Alternatives). *In the canonical families (profinite and SFT), and by inheritance (Appendix C), every compatible representation satisfies:*

1. *Hereditary rigidity:* $M_\Omega = +\infty$
2. *Universal factorization (Appendix D)*
3. *Quantified null prohibition:* $\iota(e_\star) \geq C\varepsilon_0 > 0$
4. *Non-simulability with explicit error bounds (Appendix E)*

Remark F.2 (Structural Import). This theorem establishes that the class of CCR channels is **closed** under the stated structural criteria: no extension, simulation, or compatible representation considered here escapes the structural constraints. The null regime is prohibited by mathematical necessity under those criteria, not by stipulation.

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